

Data Selection

Sometimes we want to work with only a portion of the data.

Data Selection

Data → Select Cases

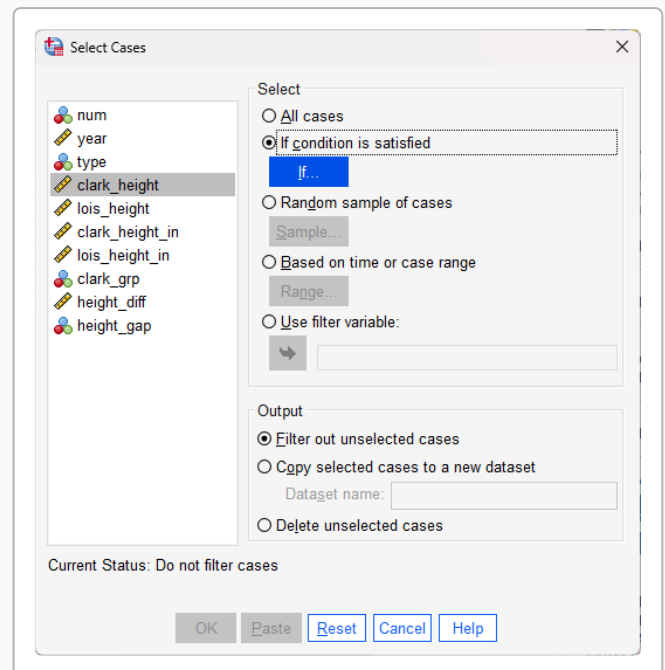
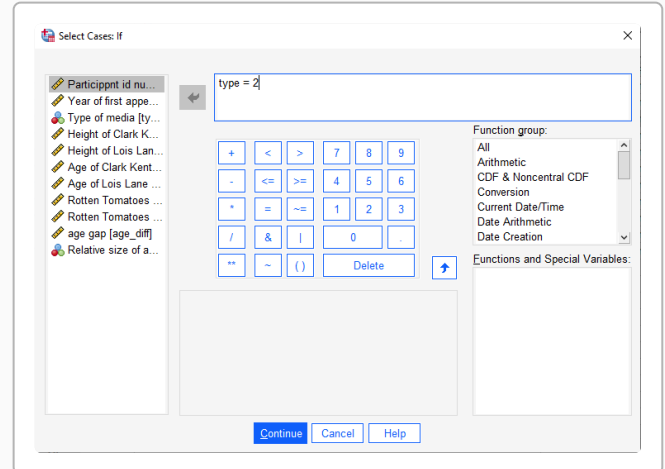
Example: We want to analyze just the data from TV Show portrayals (`type = 2`).

- 1 Click the “If condition is satisfied” radio button
- 2 Click the “If...” button
- 3 Highlight the variable name and click the arrow to move it into the window
- 4 Use the buttons or type the conditional statement (e.g., `type = 2`)
- 5 Click “Continue”, then “OK”

</> SPSS Syntax

```
USE ALL.
COMPUTE
filter_$=(type = 2).
1
VARIABLE LABELS
filter_$ 'type = 2
(FILTER)'.
2
VALUE LABELS filter_$
0 'Not Selected' 1
'Selected'.
3
FORMATS filter_$
(f1.0).
4
FILTER BY filter_$.
```

- 1 Create a filter variable based on the condition (e.g., `type = 2` selects TV Shows)
Label the filter
- 2 variable for clarity in outputs
Define value labels so SPSS displays "Not Selected" and "Selected"
- 3 Apply the filter — only selected cases will be used in subsequent analyses



! Important

To return to analyzing all data: Go back to Select Cases and click “All Cases”, or run: `FILTER OFF. USE ALL. EXE.`

	type	clark_height	lois_height	clark_age	lois_age	rt_criticism_score	rt_audience_score	age_diff	age_gap3	filter_5	var	var
1	1	75.98	1.60	32.01	35.00	83.00	90.00	-2.99	1.00	0		
2	1	75.98	1.72	26.22	30.16	88.00	86.00	-3.94	1.00	0		
3	2	74.80	1.71	24.47	23.32	78.00	72.00	1.15	1.00	1		
4	1	74.41	1.65	26.72	23.48	72.00	60.00	3.24	2.00	0		
5	1	73.23	1.63	37.94	24.91	-99.00	79.00	13.03	3.00	0		
6	1	72.83	1.63	30.11	38.82	57.00	75.00	-8.71	1.00	0		
7	3	72.83	1.62	37.24	27.11	83.00	90.00	10.13	3.00	0		
8	2	71.65	1.68	33.45	40.10	88.00	84.00	-6.65	1.00	1		
9	2	71.26	1.68	27.12	28.78	86.00	86.00	-1.64	1.00	1		
10	2	72.05	-99.00	22.78	-99.00	-99.00	-99.00	-	-	1		
11	2	72.05	-99.00	30.50	-99.00	-99.00	-99.00	-	-	1		
12												
13												
14												
15												
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18												

Split Files

Sometimes we want to get separate analyses for each of the “subsets” or “sub-groups” in our data.

Split Files

Data → Split File

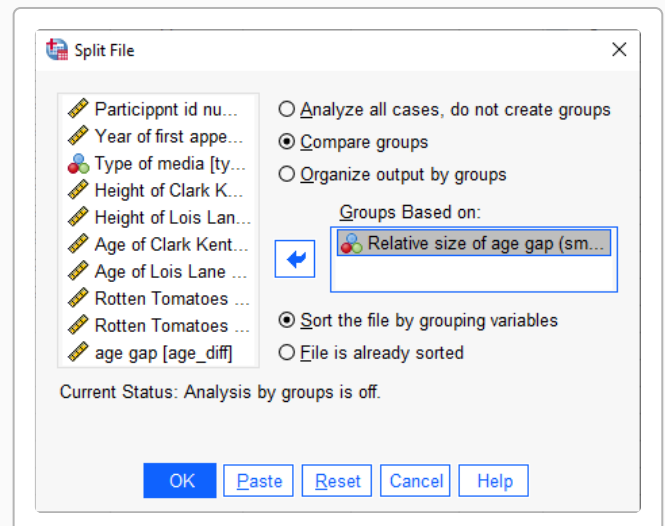
Example: We want to analyze the data for the three types of media (Film, TV Show, Serial) separately.

- 1 Click either “Compare groups” or “Organize output by groups”
- 2 Highlight the grouping variable and click the arrow to move it into “Groups Based on:”
- 3 Click “OK”

SPSS Syntax

```
SORT CASES BY type. ①
SPLIT FILE SEPARATE
BY type. ②
```

- ① Sort data by the grouping variable first (required before splitting)
Split the file so analyses run
- ② separately for each group (use **LAYERED** for side-by-side output)



 Tip**Which output option?**

- **Compare groups:** First part of output for all groups, then second part for all groups, etc.
- **Organize output by groups:** All output for group 1, then all output for group 2, etc.

Use `LAYERED` instead of `SEPARATE` for “Compare groups” output.

Unsplit a file

To return to analyzing all data together: Go back to Split File and click “Analyze all cases, do not create groups”, or run: `SPLIT FILE OFF.`

